



Labsmart Software Sample Letterhead

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**BIOCHEMISTRY**

TEST	VALUE	UNIT	REFERENCE
SERUM ALBUMIN	4.4	g/dl	3.5 - 5.2

Physiologic Basis

Major components of plasma proteins are influenced by nutritional state, hepatic function, renal function, and various diseases. It is a major binding protein, although there are more than 50 different genetic variants (alloalbumins), only occasionally does a mutation cause abnormal binding (eg, in familial dysalbuminemic hyperthyroxinemia).

Interpretation

Increased in: Dehydration, shock, hemoconcentration.

Decreased in: Decreased hepatic synthesis (chronic liver disease, malnutrition, malabsorption, malignancy, congenital analbuminemia [rare]). Increased losses (nephrotic syndrome, burns, trauma, hemorrhage with fluid replacement, fistulas, enteropathy, acute or chronic glomerulonephritis). Hemodilution (pregnancy, CHF). Drugs: estrogens.

Comments

Serum albumin indicates severity in chronic liver disease.

Useful in nutritional assessment if there is no impairment in production or increased loss of albumin. Independent risk factor for all-cause mortality in the elderly (age >70) and for complications in hospitalized and post-surgical patients.

There is a 10% reduction in serum albumin level in late pregnancy (related to hemodilution).

~~~ End of report ~~~

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